

Stuffed Zucchini Boats - Dinner at the Zoo

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Stuffed Zucchini Boats

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Sara

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These stuffed zucchini boats are filled with a hearty sausage mixture, then topped with plenty of cheese and baked to perfection. An easy low carb meal option that the whole family will enjoy!

There are so many different ways to eat zucchini, I often serve side dishes such as [parmesan zucchini](#) and [zucchini gratin](#). But my favorite way to make zucchini is to stuff it and serve it as a main course.



Hello! I'm Sara!

Welcome to Dinner at the Zoo! With 3 young kids, dinner can feel like feeding time at the zoo! I'm a mom on a mission to create easy, healthy and family friendly recipes.

[Learn More About Sara](#)





Stuffed zucchini boats is a classic dish that never goes out of style. It's an especially good choice during the summer when everyone's gardens are overflowing with squash. What I love about this dish is that it's easy to customize the flavors to your liking and is naturally low in carbs!

HOW DO YOU MAKE STUFFED ZUCCHINI BOATS?

This recipe starts with zucchini, which are hollowed out, seasoned, then placed in a baking dish. A simple meat sauce is made with Italian sausage, marinara sauce, garlic and onions. The sauce gets piled into the zucchini shells, then everything is topped with cheese and baked until gooey and browned.

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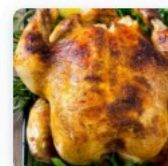
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TIPS FOR STUFFED ZUCCHINI BOATS

- You can use mild or hot Italian sausage, pork or turkey sausage, or even ground beef for this recipe.
- Use your favorite brand of marinara sauce. I typically use Newman's Own or Classico.
- You can also make this recipe with yellow squash, or even hollowed out small eggplants!
- While I typically use mozzarella cheese in this dish, other great choices would be parmesan, fontina or provolone.
- Dried Italian seasoning can be found in the spice aisle of most grocery stores, or you can use my [Italian seasoning recipe](#) to make your own.



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DINNER

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SALADS

Panzanella Salad



CAN YOU FREEZE ZUCCHINI BOATS?

I don't recommend freezing zucchini boats, simply because the zucchini will be quite mushy upon thawing. That being said, you can absolutely freeze the meat filling for these boats for up to 2 months. Simply thaw the filling, spoon it into fresh zucchinis, then add cheese and bake.

STUFFED ZUCCHINI BOAT VARIATIONS

This is an Italian style stuffed zucchini, but there are so many other great ways to fill your squash!

- Mexican: Make a filling with 1 lb ground beef, 16 ounces tomato sauce, 4 ounces diced green chiles, 3/4 cup black beans and 1/2 cup corn, then top with cheddar cheese and bake.
- Asian: Make the filling for my [chicken lettuce wraps](#), spoon it into the zucchini, then bake.
- Vegetarian: Make a filling with sauteed onion, 2 cups cooked grains such as rice or quinoa, 1 diced red bell pepper, salt, pepper, 1 1/2 cups shredded cheese, and fresh herbs.

IS ZUCCHINI HEALTHY?

Zucchini is packed with nutrients such as folate, Vitamin B6, potassium, manganese, Vitamin C and and Vitamin K. Zucchini is low calorie, low in carbohydrates and high in fiber. Zucchini also protects against inflammation, aids in digestion, improves thyroid function and is beneficial for your eyes.

This recipe is a great way to get some veggies into your kids. You can even assemble your zucchini boats earlier in the day, then store them covered in the fridge until you're ready to bake them. I make this recipe all the time and it always gets rave reviews!

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★★★★★ 4.98 FROM 142 VOTES

Stuffed Zucchini Boats



AUTHOR [SARA WELCH](#)



These stuffed zucchini boats are filled with a hearty sausage mixture, then topped with plenty of cheese and baked to perfection. An easy low carb meal option that the whole family will enjoy!

 **TIME** **Prep Time** 10 minutes **Cook Time** 40 minutes
Total Time 50 minutes

 **COURSE** **Main**

 **CUISINE** **Italian**

 **SERVES** **4**

INGREDIENTS

1X 2X 3X

- ☐ 4 medium zucchini
- ☐ 1/2 teaspoon dried Italian seasoning
- ☐ salt and pepper to taste
- ☐ 2 teaspoons olive oil
- ☐ 1 pound mild Italian sausage casings removed
- ☐ 1/2 cup onion finely diced
- ☐ 1 teaspoon minced garlic
- ☐ 2 cups marinara sauce
- ☐ 3/4 cup shredded mozzarella cheese
- ☐ 1 tablespoon chopped parsley
- ☐ cooking spray

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1 Preheat the oven to 400 degrees F. Coat a large rectangular baking with with cooking spray.
- 2 Cut the zucchini in half lengthwise, then trim off the stem ends. Use a spoon to carefully scoop the flesh out of the zucchinis.
- 3 Sprinkle the Italian seasoning, salt and pepper over the zucchini shells. Arrange the zucchini in the baking dish.
- 4 Heat the olive oil in a large pan over medium high heat. Add the sausage and cook for 4-5 minutes, breaking up the meat with a spatula.
- 5 Add the onion and cook for an additional 4 minutes or until onion is softened. Add the garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
- 6 Season the sausage and vegetable mixture with salt and pepper.
- 7 Pour the marinara sauce into the pan and bring to a simmer; cook for 5 minutes.
- 8 Spoon the meat mixture evenly into the zucchini shells, then top with the shredded cheese.
- 9 Bake for 25 minutes, or until zucchini is tender and cheese is melted and golden brown.
- 10 Sprinkle with parsley, then serve.

NUTRITION

Calories: 345kcal | Carbohydrates: 16g | Protein: 25g | Fat: 23g | Saturated Fat: 16g | Cholesterol: 102mg | Sodium: 619mg | Potassium: 1249mg | Fiber: 4g | Sugar: 11g | Vitamin A: 1065IU | Vitamin C: 47.6mg | Calcium: 182mg | Iron: 3.5mg

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ORIGINALLY POSTED

March 5, 2019

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Comments

Lanell Says:

JUNE 7, 2023 AT 12:57 PM

Can this dish be prepared and frozen for later?

[Reply](#)

Sara Says:

JUNE 12, 2023 AT 1:15 PM

That's fine, just be aware the zucchini will be much softer when frozen and thawed, and may also release excess water when reheated.

[Reply](#)

Laura L Patterson Says:

MAY 31, 2023 AT 7:56 PM

Those were the best zucchini boats I've ever made followed the recipe exactly I will definitely make them again.

[Reply](#)

Charles Says:

MARCH 22, 2023 AT 3:56 PM

Can I use the pulp from the zucchini in the sauce.

[Reply](#)

Sara Says:

MARCH 23, 2023 AT 9:29 AM

Yes that's fine!

[Reply](#)

Karen Steponkus Says:

MARCH 22, 2023 AT 3:47 PM

Great recipe! Hubby said this was a keeper! I did add the scooped out zucchini. Why waste it?! Delicious!

[Reply](#)

William Says:

MARCH 11, 2023 AT 4:07 PM

Superb recipe

[Reply](#)

Kristy Says:

MARCH 3, 2023 AT 6:58 AM

Delicious! Easy to make too. Thanks for the great recipe!

[Reply](#)

Bon Says:

JANUARY 29, 2023 AT 6:35 PM

Let me say...i love this recipe!!! I do add the scooped zucchini into the meat mixture and let it all simmer down. Fantastic recipe! Leftovers don't last long around here 😊

[Reply](#)

Jen Says:

JANUARY 23, 2023 AT 4:41 PM

Absolutely fantastic! I've been in a blended family for 1.5 years now and the meal rotation has been starting to bore me. Usually I shop at normal grocery stores, but found myself at BJ's and in front of a big bag of zucchini we would never eat as a side. Quick google and stumbled upon this recipe. The zucchinis came home & it was a hit. We ate it with rice and can't wait for the lunch leftovers tomorrow. Kids 9-15 loved it too!

[Reply](#)

Vickie Says:

AUGUST 20, 2022 AT 5:30 PM

Our family loved this recipe. I added a couple of Serano peppers and garlic pepper but it really would just be a matter of preference. Thank you for sharing 🍴

[Reply](#)

Leesa Says:

AUGUST 19, 2022 AT 11:24 AM

I made this using a very large zucchini! The only thing I added was mushroom since I had them available. I was able to give a quarter to my parents quarter to my brother a quarter to ourselves and a quarter to my sister it was a large zucchini! This is a quick easy dinner to make and you can use everything from the garden delicious!

[Reply](#)

Teri Says:

AUGUST 9, 2022 AT 12:18 PM

What do you do with the scooped out zucchini flesh?

[Reply](#)

Sara Says:

AUGUST 10, 2022 AT 9:16 AM

I discard it, but you can chop it up and add it into the meat mixture if you prefer.

[Reply](#)

Phil Says:

NOVEMBER 3, 2022 AT 5:50 PM

I usually use a 1TBSP measuring spoon. It works great.

[Reply](#)

Donna Sharp Says:

AUGUST 6, 2022 AT 2:58 PM

I received a very fresh zucchini from my neighbor that is on the larger side. My husband isn't fond of the way I usually prepare it so I thought that this would be something he would probably enjoy. I didn't follow the recipe to a T, but I got the jist of it. I added green pepper to the onion and garlic combo and I seasoned both sides of the zucchini with salt, pepper and granulated garlic. I also added chopped Basil to the sauce and omitted the Italian seasoning since jarred sauce is loaded with it.

Since the squash was larger I added 20 minutes to the cook time and I will check it for doneness ten minutes after the recommended time and go from there. I also put a nice layer of Parmigiano under the Mozzarella. The leftover sauce that I have is going into the freezer until I make lasagna. Thanks for the recipe!

[Reply](#)

JP Says:

AUGUST 4, 2022 AT 10:23 AM

I have giant zucchini's from a home garden .. way above average. Suggestions on cooking time??

[Reply](#)

Sara Says:

AUGUST 5, 2022 AT 8:31 AM

Do you know how much they weight? This recipe assumes a zucchini that's about 4 ounces.

[Reply](#)

Cheri Says:

AUGUST 6, 2022 AT 4:51 PM

I granted our big ones up and put them in 2 cup containers. I freeze for zucchini bread.

[Reply](#)

An Says:

AUGUST 1, 2022 AT 4:06 AM

Love it! Have way too many zucchini in the garden during summer, perfect recipe. Have already used lots of different fillings (Italian, Mexican and even Indian!)

[Reply](#)

John Says:

JULY 31, 2022 AT 3:56 PM

You mention adding the vegetables to the sausage in the fry pan then the marinara sauce. What vegetables? What was scooped out of the zucchini?

[Reply](#)

Sara Says:

AUGUST 1, 2022 AT 10:57 AM

I'm referring to the onions and garlic!

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